the inclination to use Islamabad against India the way China tends to do.

On the downside, Pakistan could put a spanner in India's goals in the SCO. Islamabad has been waiting in the wings to link up with Eurasia for a security, trade, and connectivity push, and it views its membership in the SCO as an important milestone. Islamabad is expected to bring a number of issues to the SCO table in order to increase its profile in the group, such as CASA-1000 and TAPI, as well as the China–Pakistan Economic Corridor (CPEC) and the Quadrilateral Traffic in Transit Agreement (QTTA).

The CPEC is the elephant in the room, as it crosses India's sovereignty red lines passing through Gilgit-Baltistan. Beijing has recently refrained from making any direct comment on Pakistan's May 2018 decision to approve the Gilgit-Baltistan Order 2018 (seen as a step in the direction of incorporating the region as the country's fifth province).[39] The Chinese official position is that the Kashmir dispute should be resolved through dialogue and consultation and that CPEC will not affect China's stand on the Kashmir issue. The CPEC could become a critical variable for Pakistan to provide the shortest route to the Indian Ocean for Central Asian states, and almost all of them have shown an interest in joining the CPEC. In comparison, India's Chabahar project, given the many hurdles, cannot provide sufficient impetus for SCO members. Clearly, the acceptance of Pakistan in Eurasia would grow henceforth. Potentially, the CPEC and QTTA will not only strain India's ties with Pakistan but also dent its relationships with other SCO states. Therefore, castigating Pakistan within the SCO has its risks for India.

China's Belt and Road Initiative